



THE EGYPTIAN • WESTERN DESERT

07

The Western Desert Oasis Tour

*Baharia to Dakhla to Kharga — dunes, escarpments
and three oases*

A journey you can picture yourself inside

From lush oasis with palms, olives and mango groves to dunes, hills, escarpments and Mars-like terrain among the White Desert formations. The route traverses old camel caravan routes and WW2 British tracks, moving oasis to oasis — Baharia, Dakhla, Kharga — with five nights camping and six in lodges.

The seventh of nine and the only tour that reaches all three oases. It is the choice for travellers who want the deep desert and the temples both, with a bed for the second half.

THE NINE, BY LENGTH IN DAYS

01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09
3	4	4	5	7	12	12	15	20

SHORTEST

EACH IS BOOKED ON ITS OWN

DEEPEST

HOW YOU TRAVEL

Vehicle · Camping and Eco-Lodges. Cairo to Cairo or Luxor · 12 days · 4 to 20 travellers. Each of the nine journeys is a separate booking with its own start and finish; none is a stage of another.

IMPORTANT

This is the intended route, not a fixed timetable.

It communicates the ground covered, the pace and the level of effort. Named properties, exact camp locations, departure times, prices and meal inclusions are confirmed at booking. Weather, park authorities, soft sand and vehicle recovery can change the order or content of a day; this guide names those dependencies wherever they affect your choice.

Every day carries the same four facts

ROUTE

Where the day starts, what it passes through and where it ends.

SLEEP

Tent or bed, and where. Camps are chosen on the day; the area is fixed, the exact spot is not.

DISTANCE

Kilometres where the source gives them, on foot for the walking tours, otherwise an estimate.

MEALS

What is included that day. Anything not listed is not included.

RHYTHM

A reading of how much the day asks of you, followed by the kind of ground it crosses.

 Easy

Road transfer, an oasis day, or a short walk. Recoverable.

 Steady

A full day of driving or walking, with stops. The normal shape.

 Demanding

Long hours, soft sand, recovery work or a hard walk. Plan around it.

FREE TIME

Noted where a day holds unstructured hours. Desert days rarely do; the group moves together and the camp is made together.

The Western Desert Oasis Tour

NIGHTS CAMPING	5 · nights 2–6
NIGHTS IN LODGES	6 · nights 1, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11
ROUND TRIP	1,200+ km on and off road
GROUND COVERED	Black Desert · Agabat · Djara Cave · White Desert · Karaween · Black Valley · Dakhla Dunes · Kharafesh · Gozmond Pass · Dakhla · Kharga

HOW THE DAYS GROUP

Baharia and the Black Desert	Days 1–2
The cave, the White Desert and the dunes	Days 3–5
Kharafesh and the escarpment	Days 6–7
Dakhla	Days 8–9
Kharga and out	Days 10–12

01

Cairo — Baharia Oasis

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Cairo → Baharia Oasis → English Mountain → the Lakes → palm groves	Eco-Lodge · Baharia	≈370 km road	Lunch, dinner

■ EASY · ROAD AND OASIS

An 0800 start from Cairo, then check in, lunch, and a tour of the oasis — the English Mountain, the lakes, the dense palm groves, and the slow pace of oasis life. Dinner at the lodge.

02

Baharia Oasis — Agabat

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Baharia → Black Desert → sandboarding → Agabat	Camp · Agabat	≈90 km, road then off-road	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · ROAD AND DUNE

Leaving the oasis behind for the Black Desert and its long-dormant volcanic hills. Lunch on route once the road is behind, a sandboarding stop, and then camp at Agabat.

03 Agabat — Djara Cave — White Desert

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Agabat → Djara Cave → White Desert National Park	Camp · White Desert National Park	≈120 km off-road	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ **STEADY · CAVE AND OFF-ROAD**

Break camp and drive to the Djara Cave for the lunch stop, then on into the White Desert National Park to camp among the formations.

04 White Desert — Karaween Dunes

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
White Desert → El Santa → Ein Khadra → the valleys → El Serw Well → Karaween Dunes	Camp · Karaween Dunes	≈80 km off-road	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ **STEADY · OFF-ROAD**

Through the White Desert past El Santa, the Roman-era acacia, and Ein Khadra, the Roman well. The route drives the small and big valleys to El Serw well for lunch, then down the Karaween dunes to camp.

05 Karaween — Black Valley — Dakhla Dunes

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Karaween Dunes → old camel routes → WW2 airstrip → Dakhla Dunes	Camp · Dakhla Dunes	≈180 km off-road	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ DEMANDING · DUNE

Sand dunes all day. The Karaween and Dakhla dunes carry the old camel routes, with a few surprise sites along the way — one of them a WW2 airstrip. Lunch on top of the Dakhla dunes, then camp among them.

06 Dakhla Dunes — Kharafesh — Gozmond

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Dakhla Dunes → camel caravan route → WW2 English track → Kharafesh labyrinth	Camp · in the labyrinth	≈60 km off-road	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ DEMANDING · REMOTE

Still on the camel route and the English track, the day travels the labyrinth of Kharafesh, which promises never-ending changing horizons. The lunch stop inside the labyrinth gives those who want it a chance to explore on foot; camp is set later within its mountains.

07

Gozmond Pass — Qasr El Dakhla

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Gozmond Pass → 350 m escarpment descent → El Qasr Mud City → Tarfa Lodge	Eco-Lodge · Dakhla	≈70 km	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ **STEADY · ESCARPMENT AND OASIS**

The descent of the Gozmond Pass drops 350 metres of escarpment into El Qasr, part of Dakhla Oasis. The mud city is visited before the lodge, which sits among the lush green of Dakhla’s countryside.

NOTE	First bed since night one. Five nights of camping end here.
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08

Dakhla — a relaxed day

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Pharaonic Tombs of Ballat → Ballat Mud City → lodge	Eco-Lodge · Dakhla	Local	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ **EASY · OASIS**

The Pharaonic tombs of Ballat and the mud city, then back to the lodge in time for lunch and a free second half of the day.

09

Dakhla — El Haggar and the Hot Well

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
El Haggar Temple → Bir El Gabal Hot Well	Eco-Lodge · Dakhla	Local	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ EASY · OASIS

A relaxed morning to explore the area or stay by the pool with a book. After lunch, El Haggar Temple and a dip in the hot well at Bir El Gabal. Dinner at the lodge.

10

Dakhla — Kharga

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Dakhla → Ancient Kellis → Kharga Oasis → Bagawat Cemetery → Mostafa El Kashef Monastery	Eco-Lodge · Kharga	≈190 km road	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · ROAD AND SITES

The drive to Kharga stops at the site of Ancient Kellis. After checking in, the Bagawat Cemetery, and for those who want it a hike up to the Mostafa El Kashef monastery.

11 Kharga – the temples

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Temple of Ghweita → Temple of Dush → Nadura Temple	Eco-Lodge · Kharga	Local, south into the oasis	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · SITES

The Temple of Ghweita, then south deeper into Kharga to the Temple of Dush, where lunch is taken, and back by way of the Nadura Temple. The last night in the Western Desert.

12 Kharga – Cairo or Luxor

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Kharga → Cairo, or Kharga → Luxor	—	Long road day	Breakfast, lunch (lunchboxes)

■ STEADY · RETURN

The drive out, with tea and coffee stops along the way. Lunch is served in lunchboxes.

NOTE	The final destination is confirmed at booking. Group splitting is not possible — Cairo or Luxor is the group's choice.
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What the price carries, and what it does not

INCLUDED

Assembly pickup and drop-off at agreed locations – 1,200+ km round trip on and off road

Hotel and lodge accommodation for 6 nights (nights 1, 7, 8, 9, 10 and 11)

Transport in reliable Toyota Landcruisers for the off-road duration

All meals listed in the itinerary

Drinks, snacks and fruit – water, tea, coffee, mint

Desert gear: kitchen, camping and recovery equipment

Tents, sleeping mats, sleeping bags and blankets

A friendly, English-speaking, experienced guide and a cook for the journey

NOT INCLUDED

White Desert National Park tickets

Temple and site entry tickets

Personal expenses

Travel and medical insurance

Alcoholic beverages

Tips and gratuities

RATES

Priced on enquiry.

The source itinerary publishes no rate card. Every one of these journeys is quoted against the group – its size, its dates and any tailoring – so the figure is set on enquiry. This panel is reserved for the rate line and the deposit terms once you supply them.

Where this journey asks more of you

The first six days are the demanding half — five nights in tents, long off-road driving and the Gozmond Pass descent. The second half is lodge-based and gentle.

The descent of the Gozmond Pass drops 350 m of escarpment into El Qasr. It is a vehicle day, not a walking one.

Minimum physical endurance is required to walk around the sites, temples and desert hikes.

Day 12 ends in Cairo or Luxor — both are available, but the group must choose one. Splitting the group is not possible.

Active November to April; can be tailored for couples, groups of four, and up to twenty travellers.

SEASON

Active November to April. Outside that window the heat makes the deep desert unworkable.

PHYSICAL DEMAND

Minimum endurance to walk the sites, the temples and the desert hikes, and to sit long hours in a vehicle over rough ground.

GROUP

4 to 20 travellers. Departures are private to the group.

VEHICLES AND GEAR

Toyota Landcruisers, stocked with supplies, kitchen, camping and recovery gear. Tents, mats, sleeping bags and blankets are provided.

TAILORING

This journey can be tailored for a specific number of travellers, and the day order can be adjusted around your dates. Contact us for an offer.

From this guide to a confirmed departure

- 01 Tell us the shape of the group**

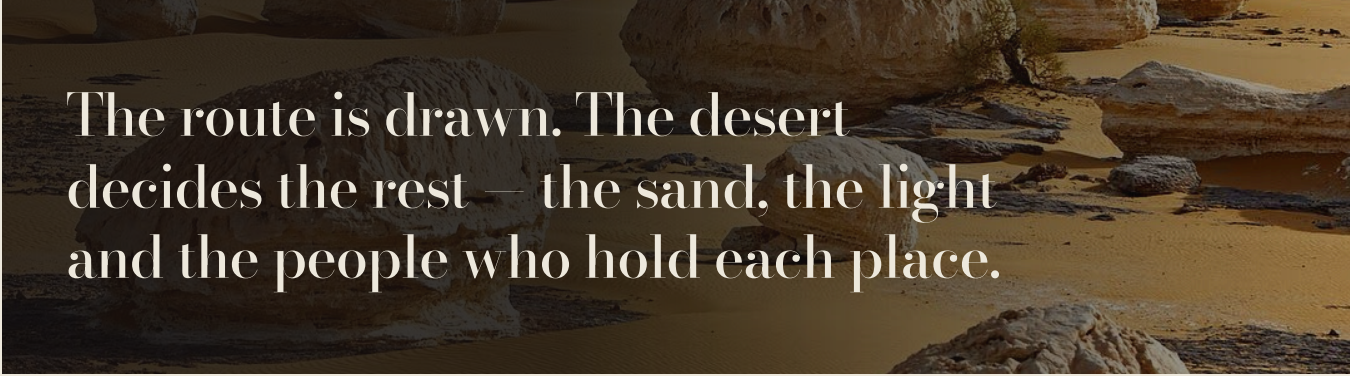
Numbers, dates in the November-to-April window, and anything the itinerary should bend around — age, mobility, diet, or a date that matters.
- 02 Receive the offer**

A quoted price against that group, with the lodges named, the vehicles counted and the inclusions fixed against this itinerary.
- 03 Confirm and prepare**

A kit list, park ticket costs, insurance requirements and the final day plan follow confirmation.

ENQUIRIES

This journey can be tailored for a specific number of travellers. Contact us for an offer against your own dates.



The route is drawn. The desert decides the rest — the sand, the light and the people who hold each place.